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Digital Literacy Project Report

Task 1 Project Report

Project Description

For this task, I designed a single-page infographic titled "Digital Literacy: Essential Skills for the Digital Age" using Canva. The infographic serves as a visual guide for my batchmates to understand the multifaceted nature of digital literacy. I structured the content along a central timeline to ensure a logical flow of information.

The design covers five key areas required for modern students:

- **Understanding Digital Literacy:** Defining it as the ability to navigate, evaluate, and create information using digital technologies effectively.
- **Professional Online Presence:** Emphasizing the importance of building a respectful and responsible digital identity.
- **Useful Digital Tools:** Identifying tools that enhance the overall student learning experience.
- **Email Etiquette:** Highlighting best practices for professional and effective digital communication.
- **Safe Internet Practices:** Providing essential guidelines for staying secure while online.

Reflections

One thing I found interesting while making this was Canva’s library of icons and visual elements, which allowed me to represent abstract concepts like "digital identity" through simple, engaging imagery. However, the most difficult part was ensuring the text remained legible against the graphical background while maintaining a clean, professional aesthetic within a single-page limit.

Task 2 Project Report

Platform Selection and Purpose

For this task, I established a professional presence on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose these three because they represent the "holy trinity" for a student specializing in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning. LinkedIn serves as my digital resume and networking hub to connect with VIT alumni and industry leaders. GitHub acts as my technical showroom where I will host code for my CSE projects and collaborate on open-source software. Lastly, I chose Kaggle because it is the premier platform for data science competitions and accessing high-quality datasets essential for my AI/ML specialization.

Four-Year Growth Plan

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a record of my evolution as an engineer. On GitHub, I aim to maintain a "green streak" by committing code regularly, eventually building a portfolio of AI models. On LinkedIn, I will document my academic milestones and internships at VIT to build a brand that attracts recruiters before graduation. On Kaggle, I plan to move from a "Novice" to a "Master" by participating in annual competitions, which will sharpen my practical machine-learning skills beyond the classroom. Together, these platforms will ensure I am industry-ready by 2029.

Task 3: Project Report

Platforms and Practice

In this module, I utilized Google Workspace, specifically Google Forms and Google Sheets, to facilitate a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz." I built a structured five-question assessment designed to test my batchmates' knowledge of cybersecurity and digital tool proficiency. After creating the form, I practiced data management by linking the form to a live Google Sheet. This allowed me to view responses in real-time, demonstrating how automated data collection can streamline the process of gathering feedback from a large group of students.

Academic Application

These tools will be indispensable throughout my journey as a Computer Science and Engineering student at VIT. Academically, I plan to use Google Forms for data collection during research projects and capstones, such as my current work in AI and ML. Being able to instantly export survey data into Google Sheets for analysis and visualization is a core skill for any engineer.

Task 4: Project Report

Communication Scenario

A significant real-world problem caused by poor digital communication often occurs during the internship hiring process. In a common hypothetical scenario, a student might send an informal, "text-style" email to a recruiter, using slang and lacking a clear subject line. This unprofessional approach often leads to the candidate being immediately disqualified, regardless of their technical skills, because it signals a lack of readiness for a professional environment.

To prevent this, the student should have utilized a structured email format with a formal salutation, a clear statement of purpose, and a professional sign-off. By treating every digital interaction as a reflection of their professional brand, the student could have demonstrated the maturity and communication skills that employers highly value in the engineering field.

Task 5: Project Report

Cybercrime Awareness

What surprised me most during my research was the sophisticated psychological engineering behind UPI fraud in India. I previously assumed cybercrime mostly involved complex hacking, but learning that most victims are simply tricked into entering their own PIN—often while feeling pressured by a "buyer"—was eye-opening. It highlighted that the human element is often the weakest link in the security chain.

As a result, the one habit I will personally change is my approach to QR codes and link-sharing. I have committed to never scanning a QR code for a transaction unless I am the one initiating the payment in a verified physical store. Furthermore, I plan to educate my peers at VIT about the "No PIN to Receive" rule, ensuring that as a Digital Ambassador, I help reduce the number of students who fall victim to these preventable financial scams.